The findings expose a critical safety gap in open weight model customisation, highlighting the need for stronger alignment safeguards and governance frameworks.

FSFE slams NHS England's reported move to privatise open source code

The Free Software Foundation Europe (FSFE) has warned that NHS England's reported plan to switch most public source-code repositories to 'private' threatens open source principles and weakens cybersecurity transparency.

Reports indicate the move is linked to concerns that publicly accessible repositories could be scanned for vulnerabilities using AI. An internal NHS policy titled 'SDLC-8' reportedly requires publicly accessible repositories to be made private unless an explicit exception is granted.

FSSE argued that depublishing repositories does not prevent attackers from analysing already-deployed systems, dependencies, interfaces, binary files, or previously copied source code. Instead, the move removes a critical layer of independent public scrutiny and collaborative vulnerability discovery.

"Depublishing public code is not a security strategy. 'Security through obscurity' has long been debunked as a security measure. Making repositories private does not protect NHS systems. It only limits who can help find and resolve problems," said Johannes Näder, senior policy project manager at FSFE.

According to FSFE, open repositories enable independent IT experts, security researchers, and public institutions to inspect, improve, reuse, and report vulnerabilities in software.

NHS England told *The Register* that the measure is temporary and intended to strengthen cybersecurity while assessing the impact of rapid AI model development. The organisation reportedly said source code would continue to be published where there is a clear need.

Menlo open sources humanoid robotics development

Menlo Research has introduced the Asimov v1 humanoid robot as an open source humanoid platform designed for builders, researchers and robotics developers, positioning humanoid robotics away from closed proprietary systems and towards reproducible engineering platforms.

Unlike many humanoid robots limited to polished demonstrations, Asimov v1 openly exposes its mechanical CAD, electrical CAD, MuJoCo simulation model, onboard software and bill of materials, allowing developers to build, train, modify, simulate and self-source the robot. Reported licensing includes CERN OHL-S 2.0 for hardware elements and GPL 2.0-style licensing for software components.

The 1.2 metre, 35kg humanoid uses 25 actuated degrees of freedom alongside two compliant passive toe joints designed to improve ground contact, walking balance and locomotion stability while reducing software control burden. The platform delivers up to 120Nm peak torque and uses a Raspberry Pi 5 alongside a Radxa CM5 compute stack.

Its sensor suite includes a monocular camera, quad microphone array, IMUs, speaker output, and joint state feedback for perception and locomotion experimentation.

Menlo Research describes Asimov v1 as a platform users can "build, train and customise." The project also includes a MuJoCo simulation environment that supports sim-to-real locomotion research, reinforcement learning, and processor-in-the-loop testing.

For more news, visit *www.opensourceforu.com*

Tether backs local AI tools with new grants

Tether has launched a new grants initiative aimed at developers building open source wallets, payment, decentralised infrastructure, and local-first AI tools on its open technology stack. The programme focuses on software that operates independently, without relying on custodians, exchanges, cloud infrastructure, or external APIs.

A major part of the initiative centres on Tether's open source Wallet Development Kit (WDK), which enables developers to embed self-custodial wallets directly into mobile, desktop, and embedded applications. The toolkit allows users to manage keys locally, sign transactions, and transfer funds without custodial intermediaries, and to integrate payments directly into applications.

The initiative is also closely tied to Tether's QVAC platform, an on-device AI system that processes data locally rather than relying on cloud-based infrastructure. Tether said the approach helps reduce dependence on third-party systems while supporting local-first AI execution.

Grants will support wallet tools, browser extensions, AI applications, peer-to-peer networking, cryptography research, infrastructure tooling, integrations, and open standards. Funding will be distributed as task-based payouts ranging from $1,500 to $4,000, paid in Bitcoin or USDT.

"We're taking a different approach. If you can build something that runs locally, has direct value, and doesn't rely on external providers, we'll fund it," said Paolo Ardoino, CEO, Tether..

The programme expands Tether's broader open source and Bitcoin-focused funding efforts, including previous grants to the BTCPay Server Foundation and donations to OpenSats.